nearly so free a correspondence or visits as in the 1920s and early 1930s before Stalin's iron curtain descended). As a matter of course, the Soviet Union was now sending a small delegation of scientists to every major international conference; such delegations were important not only for maintaining the strength of Soviet science, but also for demonstrating the Soviets' strength to Western scientists. Since the time of the tsars, Russian bureaucrats have had an inferiority complex with respect to the West; it is very important for them to be able to hold their heads up in Western public view and show with pride what their nation can do.

Thus it was that Zel'dovich, having arranged an invitation from London for Novikov to give one of the major lectures of the Relativity Conference, found it easy to convince the bureaucrats to include his young colleague in the Soviet delegation. Novikov had many impressive things to report; he would create a very positive impression of the strength of Soviet physics.

In London, Novikov presented a one-hour lecture to an audience of three hundred of the world's leading relativity physicists. His lecture was a tour de force. The results on the gravitational implosion of a mountain-endowed star were but one small part of the lecture; the remainder was a series of equally major contributions to our understanding of relativistic gravity, neutron stars, stellar implosion, black holes, the nature of quasars, gravitational radiation, and the origin of the Universe. As I sat there in London listening to Novikov, I was stunned by the breadth and power of the Zel'dovich team's research. I had never before seen anything like it.

After Novikov's lecture, I joined the enthusiastic crowd around him and discovered, much to my pleasure, that my Russian was slightly better than his English and that I was needed to help with translating the discussion. As the crowd thinned, Novikov and I went off together to continue our discussion privately. Thus began one of my finest friendships.

It was not possible for me or anyone else to absorb fully in London the details of the Zel'dovich team's no-hair analysis. The details were too complex. We had to await a written version of the work, one in which the details were spelled out with care.

The written version arrived in Princeton in September 1965, in Russian. Once again I was thankful for the many boring hours I had spent in Russian class as an undergraduate. The written analysis contained two pieces. The first piece, clearly the work of Doroshkevich and Novikov, was a